JAMES PATTERSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Engineer with 8 years of backend systems experience, specializing in cloud infrastructure and distributed systems design. I've built and scaled microservices architectures handling millions of daily transactions across AWS and Kubernetes environments. I work best when mentoring smaller teams and making architectural decisions that prevent problems rather than fix them after they happen.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Meridian Systems Ltd

Leeds, United Kingdom

meridian-systems.io

March 2022 - Present

Led the redesign of our core payment processing system, reducing latency by 65% and improving throughput from 500 to 2500 transactions per second through database optimization and service decoupling.

Established engineering standards and code review practices that reduced production incidents by 40% across eight team members, including the creation of internal runbooks and incident response procedures.

Architected a real-time data pipeline using Kafka and Flink to process event streams from multiple services, enabling the analytics team to build dashboards that decreased customer churn discovery time from weeks to hours.

Mentored four junior engineers through technical skill development and promotion paths, with two promoted to mid-level roles during my tenure.

Senior Software Engineer

CloudScale Technologies

Leeds, United Kingdom

cloudscale.co

July 2019 - February 2022

Designed and implemented a containerized microservices platform on Kubernetes that replaced legacy monolithic applications, reducing deployment times from 45 minutes to 5 minutes and enabling daily releases.

Owned the infrastructure-as-code strategy using Terraform, managing over 200 AWS resources across development, staging, and production environments with zero-downtime deployments.

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and observability using Prometheus, Grafana, and ELK Stack, allowing the team to reduce mean time to resolution for incidents from 2 hours to 15 minutes on average.

Collaborated with the platform team to establish deployment pipelines using GitLab CI, reducing manual deployment errors by 95% and freeing engineering time for feature development.

Software Engineer

TechVenture Solutions

Manchester, United Kingdom

techventure-solutions.net

September 2016 - June 2019

Built backend services in Java and Python handling concurrent requests from 500,000+ active users, focusing on API design, performance optimization, and database query efficiency.

Contributed to the migration of a monolithic application to microservices architecture, breaking down a 2 million line codebase into eight independently deployable services.

Implemented automated testing frameworks increasing code coverage from 35% to 78%, catching critical bugs before production and improving overall system reliability.

Participated in on-call rotation providing production support, responding to incidents with average resolution times under 30 minutes and maintaining 99.5% uptime.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Leeds

Leeds, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2016

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Java, Python, Go, SQL, Bash

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda, DynamoDB), Google Cloud Platform

Container and Orchestration: Docker, Kubernetes, Helm

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Cassandra

Message Brokers and Streaming: Kafka, RabbitMQ, Apache Flink

Infrastructure and DevOps: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible, GitLab CI, Jenkins

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, New Relic

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Other: REST APIs, gRPC, Linux, System Design, Microservices Architecture

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jamespatterson92/distributed-cache - In-memory distributed caching system written in Go with consistent hashing and replication support, used internally at Meridian Systems.

github.com/jamespatterson92/kafka-consumer-toolkit - Python library for building robust Kafka consumers with automatic offset management and dead letter queue handling.

github.com/jamespatterson92/k8s-deployment-templates - Collection of Kubernetes manifests and Helm charts for common application patterns including stateless services, databases, and observability stacks.

github.com/jamespatterson92/performance-benchmarks - Benchmarking suite comparing database query performance across PostgreSQL, MongoDB, and Cassandra under various load conditions.